

# From shuffled decks to first attack

A face-to-face guide for two players. Read down the page, build your formations, then begin.

| YOUR GOAL | Break through a column and reduce your opponent to 0 LP. | 20 LP EACH |
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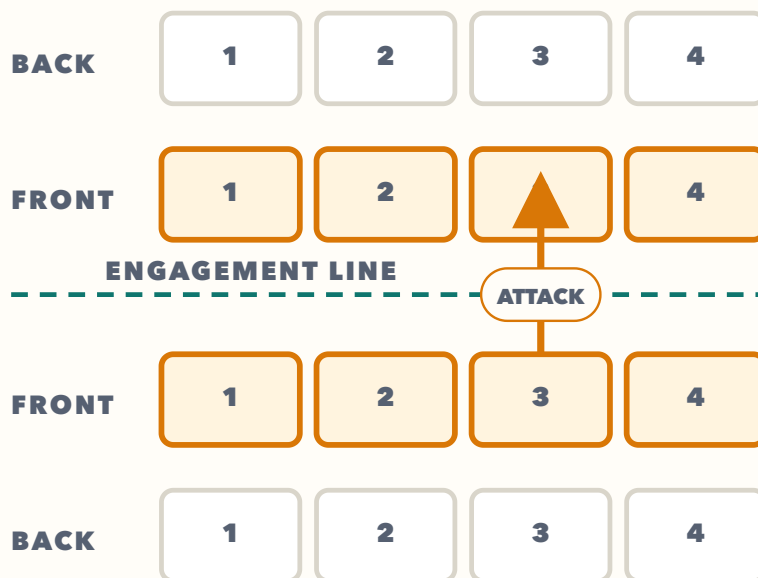
## SET UP TOGETHER

- 1 Choose sides + shuffle**  
Decide who is P1 and P2. Each player shuffles their own standard 52-card deck. Keep draw piles and hands private.
- 2 Draw 12 cards each**  
Set both Life Point counters to 20. Paper and pencil work perfectly.
- 3 Build four columns**  
Each column has a front and back slot. Every battlefield card stays face-up.
- 4 Deploy, one card at a time**  
P2 places first; alternate placements. Stop when each player has 8 cards on the field and 4 in hand. **P1 attacks first.**

## BUILD THIS FORMATION

### OPPONENT • 20 LP

all field cards face-up



### YOU • 20 LP

A front card may attack any enemy column.

**Front faces danger.** The front slot is nearest your opponent; the back slot is behind it.

## Attack once—or pass

Say the attacker and target column out loud.

### 1 • Choose

Pick one of your front cards and any enemy column.

### 2 • Resolve

Damage travels through front, back, then LP.

### 3 • Rebuild

The defender may fill empty slots in only the attacked column.

### 4 • Switch

The defender draws to 4, then becomes the attacker.

**If you pass:** draw to 4; your opponent attacks next.

**Turn over for combat →**

**Card values** Damage starts at the attacker's value. A surviving defender stops the attack.

**A = 1 • 2-10 • J/Q/K = 11**

## START THE DUEL

P1 points and says: **"My [card] in column [#] attacks your column [#]."** Keep the attacking card in its formation.

# Resolve an attack

Follow the target column from front to back. Carry only the damage that remains.

$$8 - 5 = 3$$

If damage is **less than** a defender's value, it survives and the attack stops. If damage **meets or beats** its value, discard it and carry the remainder forward.

## WORKED ATTACK • A CLUB BREAKS THROUGH

8♣ attacks a column with 5 in front and 4 in back



## EVERY ATTACK FOLLOWS THIS RHYTHM

- 1 Meet the card**  
Compare remaining damage with the next defender. Stop if it survives.
- 2 Cross the boundary**  
After a destruction, apply the suit effect only at the boundary it names.
- 3 Clear the field**  
Discard destroyed cards and slide the column forward. Surviving cards fully reset next turn.

## THE FOUR SUIT EFFECTS

|   |                               |                                                                                            |
|---|-------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ♦ | <b>DIAMOND • SHIELD</b>       | Destroyed Diamond → another card: subtract that Diamond's value from carryover.            |
| ♥ | <b>HEART • LAST GUARD</b>     | Final destroyed Heart → LP: subtract that Heart's value before LP damage.                  |
| ♣ | <b>CLUB • BREAKTHROUGH</b>    | Club attacker: double carryover once after its first destruction, if another card is next. |
| ♠ | <b>SPADE • FINISHING BLOW</b> | Spade attacker → LP: double the damage that crosses from cards into the player.            |

**If effects meet at one boundary:** subtract the shield first, apply the attacker's double second, then stop at zero.

## ACES + FACE CARDS

Classic special cards change **what can be destroyed**. An ineligible target stops the attack.

J → J

Q → J, Q

K → J, Q, K

**Ace → front Ace only.** No other attacker can destroy an Ace.

## PASSES + EMPTY DECKS

**3 consecutive passes** or **5 total passes by one player** forfeits the duel.

An empty draw pile is not a loss. Draw what you can; never reshuffle the discard pile.

## Reach 0 LP. Win the duel.

**At the table:** announce attacker and target; keep battlefield cards face-up; write down both LP totals. If a rule is disputed, pause and ask the event judge.

Long games may draw by threefold repetition, 50 turns without progress, or the 200-turn limit. Tournament clocks and pairings are organizer-defined.